Lecture 5

Management

Ethics and Professional Issues

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What Next ?

- Agricultural Society
- Industrial Society
- Information Society
- Knowledge Society ?
- AI Society ?

"THE COMPUTER SAYS I NEED TO UPGRADE MY BRAIN TO BE COMPATIBLE WITH ITS NEW SOFTWARE."

A Knowledge Society

We are entering a knowledge society in which the basic economic resource is no longer capital, or natural resources, or labour, but is and will be knowledge and where knowledge workers will play a central role.

(Peter Drucker)

Major Trends in the Knowledge based Economy

- Every industry is becoming knowledge intensive – Agriculture – growth patterns, satellite photos, weather forecasts, automatic measuring of moisture, weight,etc. using drones to spray fertiliser/pesticides, etc.
- The development of smart products – products that can take their own decisions depending on situations
- Information is more expensive than physical resources – The electronics in cars more expensive than metal
- Value in intangibles – Not recorded by traditional accounting methods- know-how, info. Systems, brands
- Trade in intangibles – the services that go with products are as valuable as the products themselves

World is Connected!
News Travels Faster than ever!

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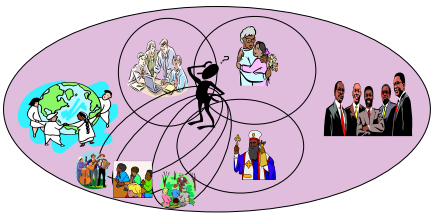
The Importance of Ethics

Ethics is the practice of making a principled choice between Right and Wrong!

ETHICS AND ETHICAL DECISION MAKING

- **COMPETING FACTORS IN DECISION MAKING**



THE TYPES OF ETHICAL CHOICES

- **COMPUTER ETHICS AND REGULAR ETHICS**
  Violation of copyrights, Privacy issues, etc.
- **Choosing Right from Wrong**
  Cheating, lying about projects vs. Truth
  Privacy of info. Vs. Profit making
- **Choosing Right from Right**
  Security vs. Convenience
  User friendliness vs. Controls
  Fully test s/w vs. On-time delivery

Legality vs. Ethicality

	Legal	Not Legal
Ethical	I	II
Not Ethical	III	IV

I = An act that is Ethical and Legal
II = An act that is Ethical but not Legal
III = An act that is not Ethical but is Legal
IV = An act that is not Ethical and not Legal

Ethics vs. Law

Law	Ethics
Formal, written document	Unwritten principles
Interpreted by courts	Interpreted by each individual
Established by legislatures	Presented by philosophers, religious, professional groups
Applicable to everyone	Personal choice
Priority decided by court	Priority determined by individual
Court makes final decision	No external decision maker
Enforceable by police and courts	Limited enforcement

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	Legal (Not Illegal)	Not Legal
Ethical	* Driving with a licence * Proper salary structure for employees * Leading by example * Truthful living	* Casual adoption of a homeless child * Euthanasia - Assisted suicide for people who are suffering and terminally ill (???) * Abortion (??)
Not Ethical	* Breaking a verbal promise * Nepotism * Suicide * Abortion (??) * Death penalty	* Sexual harassment * Rape * Physical abuse * Theft * Murder * Ragging

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Using Informal Guidelines to make Ethical Decisions

- The Mom Test
- The TV Test
- The Smell Test
- The Other Person's Shoes Test
- The Market Test

- **The Mom Test -** Discovers simply whether the individual would be proud or ashamed of an action, whether they would tell their mother what they did.
- **The TV Test -** Attempts to determine how the individual would feel if they saw their situation described on TV, whether their action would make them good or bad. How would millions of TV viewers react?
- **The Smell Test -** Simply asks whether the situation smells – gut feeling matters. Does the individual feel bad that there is a problem, but cannot pin it down. Does your instincts tell you that something is wrong?

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- **The Other Person's Shoe Test – The Golden rule -** Discovers actions that violate the ethical concept of the public interest. It asks what if the roles were reversed? Would the individual be happy if the act were done to them? If the individual would not want the roles reversed, then there is probably something wrong.
- **The Market Test –** What if the whole market or the majority of the society does the same thing. Would publicizing their action reap praise or criticism for their organisation? If the answer is criticism the action is deemed to be unethical.

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10 Commandments of Computer Ethics

1. Thou shalt not use a computer to harm other people.
2. Thou shalt not interfere with other people's computer work.
3. Thou shalt not snoop around in other people's computer work.
4. Thou shalt not use a computer to steal.
5. Thou shalt not use a computer to bear false witness.
6. Thou shalt not copy or use proprietary software for which you have not paid.

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10 Commandments of Computer Ethics

7. Thou shalt not use other people's computer resources without authorisation or proper compensation.
8. Thou shalt not appropriate other people's intellectual output.
9. Thou shalt think about the social consequences of the program you are writing or the system you are designing.
10. Thou shalt always use a computer in ways that insure consideration and respect for your fellow humans.

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The Difficulties Information & Communication Technologies Pose

- Speed of Communication
- E-Information is more "fragile" – property rights? Plagiarism? Piracy? Privacy?
- Protection of Information integrity, confidentiality and availability vs. benefits of info. Sharing

ISSUES RELATING TO THE WORKPLACE

- Ergonomics
- Monitoring
- Issues of Data Collection, Storage/Access

- Issues about Electronic Mail
- Resource Exploitation Issues

  - Planting Viruses, Hacking, Planting logic bombs
  - Using an employer's computer for personal gain
- Vendor- Client Issues
- Issues of Computer Crime

Web based Crime

- Security and Privacy of personal information and copyright issues
- Online theft, hacking, distribution of pornography, gambling
- Terrorism and warfare coordinated through the Internet

Ask yourself these questions when you are proposing to conduct business on the Internet

- Are you hiding some facts because you fear disapproval?
- Are you purposely colouring facts to bias your message?
- If what you were doing was done to you, would you feel upset?
- Could anyone object to your action as unfair?
- Will anyone be harmed by your action?
- Do you feel the need to rationalise your behaviour?
- Could a destructive trend or practice evolve?

If the answer to any of the earlier questions is "**YES**", **then you should reconsider your proposed action!!!**